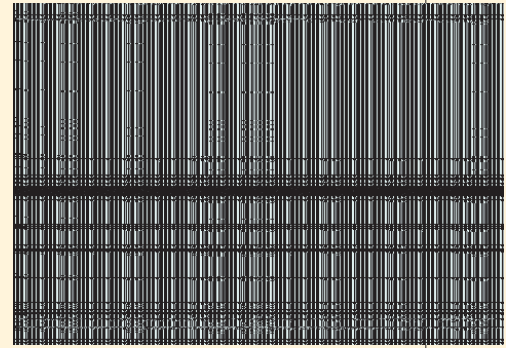


The 'Safe Mode' boot menu in Windows only appears after an improper shutdown, or when you press [F8] while booting. Can you make it appear every time Windows XP boots? Write in with the subject 'Take a crack', and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com with your solution

Make The Safe Mode Boot Option Appear Every Time Windows Starts Up



LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE



Take a Crack and Win
The Call Center Handbook
By Keith Dawson
Published by
CMP Books

LAST MONTH'S WINNER

Akshay Goel
54/7, Strachey Road,
Allahabad 211002

Rules and Regulations

Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

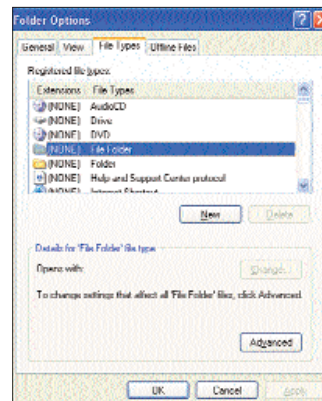
Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.

Add an item to the context menu to print out a directory listing

There are many solutions or 'hacks' to the problem, but here's the simplest solution in three steps. You create a batch file for printing out a directory, create a new action for folders, and finally do a small registry tweak.

1. Creating the Printdir.bat file:

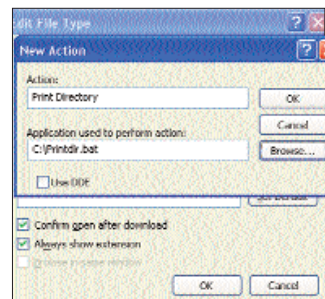


Navigate to 'File Types' in 'Folder Options'

Go to Start > Run, type in "notepad", and click OK. Copy the following text into Notepad:

```
@echo off
dir %1 /p /o:gn >
"%temp%\Listing"
start /w notepad /p
"%temp%\Listing"
del "%temp%\Listing"
exit
```

Save the file as "Printdir.bat". Place the file in your Windows directory and close it.

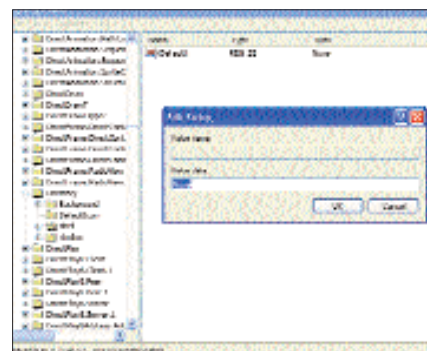


Create the new action context menu

2. Creating a new action for file folders:

Open the Control Panel. Double-click 'Folder Options', and in the 'File Types' tab, click 'File Folder'. Click 'Advanced' and then click 'New'. In the 'Action' box, type in "Print Directory".

In the 'Application used to perform action' box, enter the text "Printdir.bat". Click 'OK' thrice and close the Control Panel.

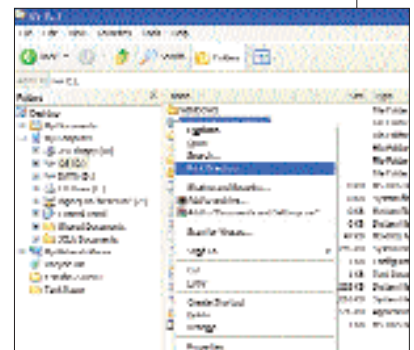


You also need to do a small registry tweak

3. Editing the Registry:

At this point, double-clicking a folder might result in the 'Search Companion' opening. In order to remedy this, you need to edit the Registry.

Open the 'Registry Editor' by going to Start > Run,



Use the context menu to print out a directory listing

typing in "regedit" and pressing OK. Locate the 'Default' entry for the key "HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\Directory\shell".

Click 'Modify' to change the value, and enter "none" in the 'File' data box. Click 'OK' and exit the 'Registry Editor'.

The required item—for printing out folders—will now appear in the context menu. ■